

Sarah Johnson

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Summary

Senior Backend Engineer with 8+ years of experience building scalable distributed systems. Expertise in Go, Python, and cloud-native architectures. Passionate about developer tooling and platform engineering.

Experience

Stripe - Senior Staff Engineer

2021 - Present

- Led the design and implementation of a new payment processing pipeline handling \$50B+ annually
- Architected event-driven microservices reducing end-to-end latency by 40%
- Mentored 5 junior engineers and established team coding standards
- Drove adoption of OpenTelemetry for distributed tracing across 200+ services

Google - Software Engineer III

2018 - 2021

- Developed core components of Google Cloud Run container orchestration layer in Go
- Optimized cold start times by 60% through prewarming strategies and binary size reduction
- Contributed to open-source Knative project (50+ merged PRs)
- Designed and implemented rate limiting service handling 1M+ requests/second

Uber - Software Engineer II

2016 - 2018

- Built real-time geospatial indexing service for driver-rider matching
- Migrated legacy Python services to Go, improving throughput 5x
- Implemented circuit breaker patterns reducing cascading failures by 80%

Education

Stanford University - M.S. Computer Science

2014 - 2016

UC Berkeley - B.S. Electrical Engineering and Computer Science

2010 - 2014

Skills

Languages: Go, Python, Java, Rust, SQL, TypeScript

Infrastructure: Kubernetes, Docker, Terraform, AWS, GCP

Databases: PostgreSQL, Redis, DynamoDB, Cassandra, Kafka

Practices: System Design, Distributed Systems, CI/CD, Observability, SRE

Open Source and Publications

- Core maintainer of go-redis (15k+ GitHub stars)
- Speaker at GopherCon 2022: "Building Resilient Payment Systems in Go"
- Published: "Patterns for Scalable Event Processing" (InfoQ, 2023)